Digital Literacy Project Report

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

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Branch: BTech – Computer Science and Engineering (Core)

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Introduction

This report is submitted as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The project scenario involved taking on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador — a peer guide who helps other students make smarter, safer, and more professional use of digital tools. I completed five tasks across different areas of digital literacy: visual communication through infographics, building an online professional presence, using coding and collaboration platforms, writing professional emails, and understanding cybercrime. Rather than just learning how these tools work, this project pushed me to think about why responsible and informed use of them matters — both in university and beyond. This report walks through each task, what I did, what I learned, and what I would do differently.

Task 1 – Creating a Digital Literacy Infographic

I created this infographic using **Canva**, an easy-to-use online design tool that provides templates, icons, and layout options for visually appealing content. My design represents the impact metrics of a Digital Literacy Program, focusing on key areas such as skill proficiency, online safety, cybersecurity awareness, and professional presence. Each section highlights a specific percentage to show measurable outcomes—for example, 85% skill proficiency and 70% awareness of online safety practices. I used a consistent colour scheme (yellow, blue, and grey) along with icons and images of students to make the information engaging and easy to understand.

One interesting aspect of creating this design was learning how to balance text and visuals so that the infographic does not look cluttered but still conveys meaningful data. The most challenging part was aligning elements properly and maintaining visual hierarchy—deciding which information should stand out more, such as the large percentage figures. Overall, this task helped me understand how design can effectively communicate data in a simple and impactful way.

Task 2 – Building a Student Digital Portfolio

This task involved setting up and updating profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. On GitHub, I created a profile README.md that introduces who I am, my current branch and year, and a short note on what I am working towards during my degree. GitHub functions as a live, evolving portfolio — recruiters and internship teams regularly look at GitHub profiles to understand what a candidate has actually built. On LinkedIn, I updated my education details to reflect my current programme at VIT Bhopal University and IIT Madras and started building out the profile structure that I will fill in as I progress through my degree. Kaggle was new territory for me — it is a platform built around data science competitions and real-world datasets, which makes it a good place to practice applied machine learning outside of coursework.

Starting these profiles in first year rather than final year felt like the right move. Building a portfolio over time is far more convincing than filling everything in during placement season. My goal is to use GitHub to track every project I work on, LinkedIn to connect with alumni and professionals in AI and computer science, and Kaggle to sharpen data-related skills through practice. Screenshots of all three profiles are stored in the task-2-portfolio/ folder.

Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Part A involved registering on HackerRank and completing the Solve Me First challenge. The problem itself is straightforward — read two integers and return their sum — but the exercise was really about getting comfortable with the platform's code editor, submission workflow, and output format. I also worked through the Python Introduction challenge to reinforce basic syntax in a structured environment. Screenshots are saved in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

Part B involved building a Google Form titled Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. The form contains five questions covering the themes from this course — digital literacy concepts, safe internet habits, and professional communication. The question types include multiple choice and one short answer question. I linked the form responses to a Google Sheet so the data could be tracked and reviewed. The form link is included in the repository README.md, and screenshots of both the form and the response sheet are in task-3-platforms/. Both tools have real practical use: HackerRank is something I will keep using between assignments to stay sharp, and Google Forms will almost certainly come up again in group projects and surveys.

Task 4 – Professional Email Writing and Etiquette

Email 1 – Assignment Extension Request

To: kannan@vitbhopal.ac.in
Subject: Request for Extension on Digital Literacy Assignment Submission

Respected Professor Kannan,

Hope you are doing well.
I am writing to request a brief extension for the Digital Literacy assignment due on 30th March 2026. I have been unwell over the past few days and have not been able to complete the work at the level I want to submit.

I have made significant progress and only need two additional days to finish and review the remaining sections. If possible, I would appreciate an extension to 27th March 2026. I completely understand if that is not feasible and am prepared to submit my current draft if required.
Thank you for your time and consideration.

Regards,

Akshit Bhatia

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B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering (Core)

Email 2 – Internship Enquiry

To: hiringmanager@infosys.com
Subject: Interest in Summer Internship – First Year CSE Student, VIT Bhopal

To whosoever it may concern,

I hope this email finds you well. My name is Akshit Bhatia and I am a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University. I am writing to express my interest in the summer internship programme at Infosys, specifically in the AI and Machine Learning division.

I have been actively building my technical skills through coursework and platforms such as HackerRank, and I document my projects on GitHub. I am eager to gain hands-on experience in machine learning and data analysis, and I believe contributing to your team would offer exactly the kind of real-world exposure I am looking for at this stage of my degree.

I have attached my resume and would be happy to share any further information. Thank you for considering my application.

Regards,

Akshit Bhatia

akshit.25bce10582@vitbhopal.ac.in

VIT Bhopal University

Reflection on Digital Communication Etiquette

One situation that comes up repeatedly on campus is students sending informal, rushed messages to faculty. A message like 'Sir need marks urgently, send asap' does not convey a lack of intelligence — it conveys a lack of consideration for the person being addressed. The faculty member may respond minimally not because they are unhelpful, but because the message signals that the sender has not taken the interaction seriously. A properly formatted email — with a subject line, a respectful opening, clear context, and a polite closing — changes the entire dynamic. The content of the request matters far less than the tone and structure in which it is delivered, especially in formal academic or professional settings.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: Phishing Case Study

Phishing – Case Study

Phishing is one of the most widespread forms of cybercrime and remains highly effective despite widespread awareness campaigns. The core tactic involves sending a message that appears to come from a trusted source — a company, an institution, or a known contact — in order to trick the recipient into handing over sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, or personal identification data.

A realistic scenario targeting students goes as follows: a college student receives an email that looks like it has come from a well-known company, offering a paid internship position. The email has a professional layout, a convincing subject line along the lines of 'Urgent: Internship Offer — Response Required Within 12 Hours', and a link to a form asking for academic details and email login credentials under the pretence of account verification. The tight deadline is deliberate — it is designed to stop the recipient from pausing to think critically. The student, excit ed by the opportunity and under time pressure, fills in the form without checking whether the sender's email address is legitimate or whether the company's official website mentions any such programme. Within hours, they begin receiving notifications of unauthorised login attempts to their accounts.

Students and young professionals are frequent targets because they are actively search for opportunities and are statistically more likely to respond quickly. The consequences range from unauthorised account access and identity theft to loss of personal data and lasting anxiety around online platforms.

Personal Reflection

Researching this topic shifted something in how I think about online safety. I had always assumed phishing worked because people simply did not know about it. What I found is that these attacks are engineered around human psychology — they exploit excitement, urgency, and the fear of missing out. Someone who knows exactly what phishing is can still fall for it when the emotional conditions are right. The habit I am taking away from this task is straightforward: before clicking any link that asks for personal information, I will take thirty seconds to check the sender's email address against the official domain and verify on the company's actual website whether the opportunity is real.

Conclusion

Before starting this project, I thought digital literacy was essentially a synonym for knowing how to use the internet and common software. Completing all five tasks gave me a more grounded understanding — it is about using digital tools with intention, communicating professionally, representing yourself honestly across platforms, and

staying alert to the risks that come with being online. Each task offered something practical: designing for clarity, structuring a professional email, building a portfolio early, practicing coding consistently, and recognising the psychological tactics behind cybercrime. The GitHub repository I built through this project is something I plan to keep developing throughout my degree — not as a one-time submission, but as a genuine running record of what I am learning and building.

References

- Canva – canva.com (used for Task 1 infographic design)
- GitHub – github.com (used for Task 2 portfolio and project repository)
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com (used for Task 2 professional profile)
- Kaggle – kaggle.com (used for Task 2 data science portfolio)
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com (used for Task 3 coding practice)
- Google Forms – forms.google.com (used for Task 3 quiz)
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in (referenced in Task 5)
- CERT-In Cyber Safety Guidelines – cert-in.org.in (referenced in Task 5)